

Your Website: The Complete Owner's Guide

Double Treble Stitches — written for you, no tech experience needed

Your website lives on **Netlify** (free). It never breaks, never needs updates, and you never have to maintain anything. Day to day, your website is just... email: **when someone orders, you get an email. You reply. That's the whole job.** This guide covers the one-time setup and the rare occasions you'll ever log in to Netlify.

The only 3 things you'll ever do	How often
Read order emails in Gmail and reply to customers	Whenever an order comes in
Ask your developer (Michael) when you want something changed	Whenever you like
Log in to Netlify	Almost never — only for the one-time setup and the rare peek at old orders

PART 1 — Putting your website online (one time, ~10 minutes)

You'll need: the zip file your developer sent you, and your Netlify account.

Step A — Unzip the package

1. Find the zip file (double-treble-stitches-netlify.zip) in your Downloads folder.
2. Double-click it (Mac) or right-click → **Extract All** (Windows).
3. Open the new folder it made. Inside you'll see a folder called **build**, one called **netlify**, and some guides (PDF files). The **build** folder IS your website.

Step B — Upload to Netlify

1. Go to **app.netlify.com/drop** and log in.
2. Drag the **build** folder (just that folder — not the zip, not the outer folder) onto the dashed area on the page.
3. Wait about 30 seconds. Netlify shows your site is live with an address like *random-name-123.netlify.app*.
4. Click that address — you should see your website. Congratulations, it's online!

■ *If the page says "Not Found" or "404": you dragged the wrong folder. Don't worry — click **Deploys** in the left menu, scroll to the bottom, and drag the **build** folder onto the drop zone there. Fixed.*

PART 2 — Give your site a nicer address (2 minutes)

1. In Netlify, click **Site configuration** (left menu) → **General** → **Site details**.
2. Click **Change site name**, type: **doubletreblestitches** and save.
3. Your free address is now **doubletreblestitches.netlify.app** — easy to remember and share.

PART 3 — Make order emails come to you (5 minutes, one time)

Right now orders are only stored in Netlify. This step sends each one to **doubletreblests@gmail.com** too.

1. Click **Site configuration** → **Forms** → **Form notifications**.
2. Click **Add notification** → **Email notification**.
3. Event to listen for: **New form submission**.
4. Email to notify: **doubletreblests@gmail.com**
5. Form: choose **order-request** → **Save**.
6. Do it once more, identical, but Form: **pattern-waitlist** → **Save**.

■ *First emails may land in Gmail's Spam folder — open one, click "Not spam", and Gmail learns forever.*

PART 4 — Test everything (5 minutes)

1. Open your live site, scroll to the order form, and send yourself a pretend order (use your own email).
2. Also type your email into the "Notify me at launch" box in the Patterns section and submit.
3. Within a minute: both appear in Netlify under **Forms**, and both emails arrive in your Gmail.
4. Happy? In Netlify → Forms, click each form, select the test entries, and delete them so everything starts clean.

PART 5 — Reading your orders (the rare Netlify visit)

1. Log in to Netlify → click your site → **Forms** (left menu).
2. Click **order-request** to see every order ever sent, including any inspiration photos customers attached (click the photo link to view/download it).
3. Click **pattern-waitlist** to see everyone waiting for your patterns — handy when you launch them.
4. Want a spreadsheet? There's an **Export CSV** button on each form's page.

PART 6 — Getting your own domain (like doubletreblestitches.com)

Optional but lovely. About \$10–15/year. Do this whenever you're ready.

1. Buy the domain from any registrar — Namecheap, GoDaddy, Cloudflare, Squarespace Domains, all fine.
2. In Netlify: **Site configuration** → **Domain management** → **Add a custom domain** → type your domain → verify.
3. Choose **Use Netlify DNS** when offered (the easy road).
4. Netlify shows you 4 nameserver addresses. Go back to where you bought the domain, find **Nameservers** (sometimes under "DNS" or "Manage"), and replace what's there with those 4 Netlify ones. Save.
5. Wait anywhere from 10 minutes to a few hours. Netlify adds the secure padlock (HTTPS) automatically — nothing to do.

■ *Stuck on nameservers? Every registrar has a help page called "change nameservers" — or ask your developer, it's a 2-minute fix.*

PART 7 — When you want something changed

New photos, different prices, a new product, the holiday banner date — **you never edit the site yourself.**

1. Text or email your developer (Michael — michaelbailie88@icloud.com) with what you want changed. Attach any new photos.
2. He keeps the master files, makes the change, and sends you a fresh zip.
3. The 3-click update: Netlify → **Deploys** → drag the new **build** folder onto the drop zone at the bottom. Live in 30 seconds. The forms, notifications, and domain all keep working — nothing to set up again.

■ *If you'd rather not even do the drag-and-drop, just ask Michael — with your okay he can do it for you on a quick call.*

PART 8 — If something seems off

What you see	What to do
--------------	------------

Site says "Not Found"	Wrong folder was uploaded. Netlify → Deploys → drag the build folder (from inside the zip) onto the drop zone
Order email didn't arrive	Check Gmail spam → mark "Not spam". Still nothing? Netlify → Site configuration → Forms → Form notifications → make sure both forms are listed with doubletreblests@gmail.com
Can't log in to Netlify	Use the same button you signed up with (e.g. "Log in with GitHub"). Or click "Forgot password". Check your email for a Netlify verification link
A customer says the form failed	Ask them to try once more. If it keeps happening, tell Michael
Anything else	Text Michael. That's what he's for

KEEP THIS PAGE — your quick reference

Thing	Where / what
Your website	doubletreblestitches.netlify.app (or your custom domain once added)
Netlify login	app.netlify.com — the account you created
Order emails go to	doubletreblests@gmail.com
Instagram	@doubletreblests
Changes & master files	Michael — michaelbailie88@icloud.com
Detailed technical guide	The "Netlify Forms Guide" PDF in the same package

You don't need to understand any of the technology — the site just works, and help is one message away. Now go crochet something beautiful. ■

Double Treble Stitches · Handmade with love